



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

DR Congo: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-20

Edition of 2026-08-20-2 · 114 systems and instruments tracked, 13 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-20 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 114 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 60 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-20, 15 did not, 26 carry no stated baseline, and 13 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 174 sources for this place in the window — 32 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 142 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Most of what moved in this window was written rather than built. The clearest movement with figures at both ends is fiscal. The digital economy section's domestic appropriation went from [FC 60,627,481,411 revised for FY2025](#) to [FC 81,698,223,741 for FY2026](#), and posts and telecommunications from FC 40,138,356,283 to FC 53,840,917,417 — but the two sections were also renamed and their mandates redistributed, so the rise is substantially a transfer.

The identity platform is the largest system to have changed state: from a [twenty-year exclusive know-your-customer partnership signed in June 2025 with nothing live](#) to a [platform launched on 13 June 2026, valued at US\\$97.1m](#), still with no enrolment figure published. The supervisory authority the code has required since 2023 [remains uncreated at both ends of the window](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Africa Congo Internet Exchange	Established 2023 and operating from a single presence	A distributed exchange across two carrier-neutral facilities, open to licensed operators, service providers, mobile networks, cloud and content providers	ADVANCED
DRC mobile subscription and internet-penetration statistics (EACO regional report)	No EACO/ARPTC-sourced figure held	73.93m mobile subscriptions, 67.8% penetration (from 63.96m/60.5% in 2024); 36.98m mobile-internet subscriptions, 33.9% penetration; mobile-internet revenue US\$970.2m in 2025, nearly matching voice revenue; DRC reports no mobile-money transaction value to EACO	ADVANCED
Goma-Mombasa fibre route	Did not exist	Eastern DR Congo tied into the East African terrestrial corridor to the Indian Ocean	ADVANCED
National digital transformation project fibre backbone	The programme running about a year with no deployed-kilometre figure held; the June 2025 Council recorded 30.79% mobile-internet and under 0.02% fixed access	7,000 km deployed against a target of more than 18,500 km, leaving 11,500 km outstanding, tied to connecting 145 territories by 2030	ADVANCED
5G public consultation	The consultation open since 2025-03-18 with no outcome published	Unchanged: no consultation report, spectrum award, licence or revised timetable seventeen months later	NO CHANGE
Rural solar base-station joint venture	Announced January 2025: up to 2,000 solar 2G and 4G base stations over six years, reaching about 19m people	The same commitment restated sixteen months later with a 2031 date; no sites-built count, spend figure or first-phase milestone at either end	NO CHANGE
Sovereign satellite programme	A memorandum signed November 2024; cost estimated at US\$400m and said to be mobilised	Unchanged: no contract, operator selection, build or launch date, and no revised cost on record in the following twelve months	NO CHANGE
State telecommunications and postal operator	A national conference on posts and telecoms named the sector the state's second-largest revenue source and asset spoliation a problem to fix	On current finances the company could theoretically pay salaries only every four months; management says rigour has brought the cycle to every two to two and a half months	NO CHANGE
Satellite direct-to-cell service	Baseline not held	Commercially launched on 2026-08-14, the first African operator to move a satellite-to-mobile partnership out of testing; a compatible LTE Android handset with a clear view of the sky reaches messaging, SMS and voice by satellite where there is no terrestrial coverage, with no dish, router or other equipment, the regulator has confirmed a phased rollout, and eligible customers registering through the operator's app get a free 30-day introductory trial	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National data centre appropriation	No national data-centre appropriation is established at the window's start	Appropriated in the enacted 2026 budget; no procurement, site, operator, specification or execution evidence is held	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Raxio group committed capital	US\$350m committed capital	US\$380m committed capital, with six times as much power contracted in the first half of 2026 as in the first half of 2025	ADVANCED
Kinshasa carrier-neutral data centre	Live since August 2024 as the country's first Tier III certified facility	The same certified position, now also hosting the internet exchange's second presence	NO CHANGE
Raxio Kinshasa data centre	Operating since August 2024 as the country's largest data centre	Tier III certified, 400 racks over 1,542 square metres, 1.5 MW, US\$30m invested; no utilisation, capacity-sold or expansion figure is held	NO CHANGE
Sovereign government cloud	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named as an existing ministry project alongside the digital and data strategies, the identity platform and a certification authority; no hosting location, operator, procurement, budget line or date is stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Child online-safety service	Did not exist	A subscriber-level filtering service applying preset policies to a child's traffic, blocking adult, illegal, gambling and hate content and social platforms other than one messenger, from 50 units for 30 days	ADVANCED
National cybersecurity agency	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named alongside a cybersecurity council, the data-protection authority, the central bank and the telecommunications regulator; whether the agency exists in law, is staffed or is operating is not established	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The backbone acquired a measurable position it did not have. At the window's start the programme had run about a year with no deployed-kilometre figure held, and the [June 2025 Council recorded 30.79% mobile-internet and under 0.02% fixed access](#); by 3 August 2026 it stood at [7,000 km](#) against more than [18,500 km](#), leaving [11,500 km](#) over a 2030 horizon. Two connectivity assets appeared alongside it: an [eastern route to Mombasa](#) and a second presence for the internet exchange, making it [the country's first distributed exchange](#).

State data-centre capacity moved on paper only, from no established appropriation to [FC 26,756,546,346 in the enacted 2026 budget](#), with no procurement or site.

Three positions did not move, each with an announcement at both ends: a rural joint venture's [2,000 solar base stations, restated with a 2031 date](#) and no sites-built count; a [US\\$400m sovereign satellite](#) with no contract or launch date; and a [5G public consultation open since March 2025](#) with no report, spectrum award or licence seventeen months later.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Data-sharing platform and government payment gateway	BASELINE NOT HELD	Specified on paper only: no architecture, pilot, operator or date, and the interoperability framework is itself a consultant deliverable	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National electronic certification authority	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named, not established; a July 2026 interministerial order already prices qualified trust services at US\$30,000 foreign and US\$10,000 local	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
RDC-PASS national digital identity platform	A twenty-year exclusive electronic know-your-customer partnership signed June 2025, phased deployment under way, no platform live	Platform launched 2026-06-13, valued at US\$97.1m by the planning ministry, with US\$2.6m raised by the concessionaire for initial rollout; no enrolment figure published	ADVANCED
Second national identification and card issuance	A card-production partner under discussion, no start date and no financing route	Start of operations announced as imminent, the partner withheld; the 2026 finance law gives national-identification acquisition FC 20,654,178 and revised provisions sit in a supplementary budget before the Assembly	ADVANCED
Biometric passport	US\$75 a passport, 50 fixed and mobile stations plus 50 at missions, 2,400 a day	Unchanged; no later price, volume or station figure is held	NO CHANGE
Birth registration in a rural eastern sector	BASELINE NOT HELD	No birth registers for several months and newborn registration stopped outright; the province promised resupply with no date	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Card-and-wallet interoperability service	Did not exist	Live since the fourth quarter of 2025, and now the rail on which a stablecoin settlement use case runs	ADVANCED
Microfinance and cooperative digitalisation platform	Did not exist	Scope is core banking, enterprise resource planning and card modules, 10,000 payment terminals with biometric authentication, chip cards, and connection of microfinance institutions and cooperatives to the national switch across 145 territories; nothing deployed on file	ADVANCED
Palm-vein biometric payment terminal	Did not exist	Launched and stated as integrated into national payments infrastructure, named against the 2023-2028 financial-inclusion strategy	ADVANCED
Prepaid card partnership	Did not exist	Announced; the domestic partner serves more than three million customers through 4,000 agents and 160 agencies across both Congos, with 27 services on its application	ADVANCED
Stablecoin settlement of mobile-wallet top-ups	Did not exist	Live, bypassing correspondent banking, which carries about 8% of sub-Saharan remittance cost; the dollar peg is inferred rather than disclosed	ADVANCED
Mobile-money accounts	29m accounts and 34.6% penetration	Still the only dated, attributable figure; an operator cites about 35m users in April 2026 and the base holds 24m, 29m, 30m and 35m across sources	NO CHANGE
Central bank de-dollarisation deadline	BASELINE NOT HELD	The deadline stands at 2027-04-09 with no implementing instrument, exemption schedule or enforcement mechanism held	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Biometric civil-servant registry cards issued	More than 118,000 cards across 26 provinces	Unchanged; no updated enrolment figure published in the twelve months to 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Single social register	The decree adopted, no register built	Unchanged: no signed decree text, no operator, no household enrolment and no link to the identification office at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Business-creation single window	BASELINE NOT HELD	The portal proposes a legal form and tracks a file in real time, and the application issues sole-trader attestations in under 48 hours; full online company creation is not possible, the chain still spanning the revenue directorate, a collecting bank, the notariat and verification	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Credit-risk and movable-collateral registries	Not held	Announced as a modernised credit-risk registry and an electronic movable-collateral registry to be built with the central bank, alongside a new deposit-guarantee fund, as part of a World Bank package to expand financing for small and medium firms; the same package carries a rollout of 10,000 point-of-sale terminals and agent networks	BASELINE NOT HELD

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Economic-inspection document authentication platform	Did not exist	Staff trained on a platform to authenticate documents against forgery for economic inspections; no deployment date, coverage or transaction figure	ADVANCED
Facture normalisée (standardised VAT e-invoicing system)	Did not exist	Mandatory since 1 December 2025 for all VAT/ICG-liable firms after a two-month moratorium and a further 30-day compliance grace period; the state distributed more than 4,000 free billing units and electronic fiscal devices to VAT-liable SMEs; quarterly VAT mobilisation risen from a CFC 280-290bn average to CFC 340bn, still 'very largely below potential' per the finance minister	ADVANCED
Higher-education portal and national digital library	Did not exist	Live for student identification, transcripts and equivalences	ADVANCED
Public-enterprise digitalisation plan 2026-2028	Did not exist	A roadmap announced covering transaction traceability, automated validation circuits, real-time alerts and data reconciliation across state enterprises; no system, budget line or deployment date named	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital government platform	<i>Baseline not held</i>	A first-quarter 2026 target set in January 2026; no platform, revised date or announced delay at 2026-08-06	STALLED
Employment agency AI job-matching platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Out to tender for AI modules to be developed, integrated and deployed on the national employment agency's existing digital platform	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National e-government strategy 2025-2030	BASELINE NOT HELD	Named but not operational: strategic priorities, master plan, governance framework, enterprise architecture and interoperability framework are all still to be defined by a consultant not yet appointed	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Kinshasa drone surveillance and citizen-reporting application	Did not exist	Deployed, with the reporting outlet itself raising privacy and operator-integrity concerns; no procurement value, legal basis, data-retention rule or oversight arrangement is held	ADVANCED
Airport levy electronic payment, Kinshasa province	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced for July 2026 through a private technical partner with real-time transaction tracking; whether it went live is not established at 2026-08-06	Baseline not held
Kinshasa urban administration payroll arrears	BASELINE NOT HELD	Two months of arrears outstanding, with beneficiary listings already transmitted to the paying bank but neither bank staff nor payroll agents attending the appointed payment	Baseline not held

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital sector strategic barometer	Did not exist	Announced to give government figures on firms' scope of activity, turnover, growth and job creation; no operator, methodology or first-issue date stated	ADVANCED
Second general population and housing census	BASELINE NOT HELD	The cartographic phase recruiting and enumeration scheduled for July 2027; it would be the first census since 1984	Baseline not held

Identity moved at both ends of the same problem. The concession-run platform [went live in June 2026](#); the state's own identification programme went from a [card-production partner under discussion with no financing route to operations announced as imminent](#), financed by a partnership because the finance law fell short. The appropriation for national identification acquisition is [FC 20,654,178](#).

Payments gained four rails and no measurement. A [card-and-wallet interoperability service](#), a [stablecoin settlement of wallet top-ups](#), a [palm-vein payment technology](#) and a [microfinance digitalisation agreement covering 10,000 payment terminals and connection to the national switch](#) all entered the record from nothing. Against them, the account base did not move: the only precisely dated figure remains [29m accounts and 34.6% penetration for the fourth quarter of 2024](#), with 24m, 30m and 35m also on file and none reconcilable.

Three government systems held still. The [digital government platform passed a first-quarter 2026 target with neither launch nor delay announced](#); the [single social register has no signed decree, operator or household enrolment](#) twelve months after its draft decree was adopted in council; and the [biometric civil-servant registry stands where it did at 118,000 cards](#), its US\$250m commitment five months from closure with no published outturn.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Bill on the identification of natural persons	Did not exist	Tabled; it would set one legal frame for identification data and its collection, processing, retention and protection, impose security and interoperability requirements and connect civil-registry, migration and health databases; no committee report or plenary date is held	ADVANCED
Interministerial order on digital-sector duties, taxes and fees	Did not exist	A two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant: cloud services US\$5,000 local and US\$15,000 foreign in the first tier against US\$2,500 and US\$10,000 in the second; data-centre declaration from US\$25,000 to US\$100,000 by tier; one startup line at US\$100. In force on signature 2026-07-20 under its article 5; a surseance announced by the finance ministry on 1 August 2026 and denied on 6 August 2026, neither position resting on a published government text; ministry's 8 August statement confirms registered 'entreprenant' start-ups are now fully exempt (not merely the US\$100 line reported earlier), still with no gazetted order or amending text published	ADVANCED
Code du numérique	The framework law in force, its third book governing personal data, with no data-protection authority operational	The same law in force, a legal scholar dating the shift from an embryonic 2020 telecom law to extensive data-protection coverage	NO CHANGE
Satellite internet service-provider licence	Licensed since May 2025	Still licensed; the licence conditions, spectrum awards and any enforcement outcome are not established	NO CHANGE
Social register decree	A draft decree adopted in council	No promulgated decree number, signature date or publication held at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Joint subcontracting enforcement by two regulators	BASELINE NOT HELD	A harmonised reading of the legal texts, joint inspection teams and enforcement of local-content subcontracting rules on large operators, with scope stated beyond telecoms to digital services and electronic commerce	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital governance framework	Did not exist	Instruments to be articulated named as the digital and data strategies, the AI strategy, the identity platform, the sovereign cloud, a certification authority and a cybersecurity agency; plus critical-infrastructure mapping, a minimum security baseline, reference data registries, a single digital identity, and no AI platform deployed without data quality, auditability and human supervision; the regulator's president stated on 2026-07-30 that the working groups had proposed a six-to-twelve-month timetable for the main actions, with an action matrix and a monitoring mechanism to follow	ADVANCED
National digital plan 2026-2030	Did not exist	A US\$1.5bn envelope: US\$1bn of treasury investment over five years plus US\$500m of external partner support; no finalised published plan document is locatable	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Reorganisation of the digital mandate in the 2026 finance law	One section titled posts, telecommunications and new technologies and another titled digital	The first renamed posts and telecommunications and the second renamed digital economy, with credits moving from FC 145.7bn to FC 55.1bn and from FC 60.6bn to FC 226.7bn	ADVANCED
Sectoral digital economy policy 2026-2030	Did not exist	Validated and referred to the Council of Ministers for adoption, on axes covering infrastructure, digital transformation of the administration, the digital economy, innovation and start-ups, cybersecurity, and data governance; not published, not costed and not budgetable	ADVANCED
National strategy for mobile and broadband coverage	Baseline not held	A National Connectivity Strategy 2026-2035 built on a shared-infrastructure model led by a tower company, with subsidy agreements signed with the four mobile operators to extend service to 40 underserved localities covering about 258,000 people, and a target of 3,000 localities and 16 million people by 2030	BASELINE NOT HELD

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
African Telecommunications Union headquarters	Headquarters outside the country, with arrears outstanding	Return ratified after more than US.4m of arrears was paid; no date for the move is stated	ADVANCED
Regional free-roaming resolution	BASELINE NOT HELD	The deadline has passed with no implementation, tariff or country-specific measure held	Baseline not held
Regional satellite data-residency framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	It would require non-geostationary providers to establish terrestrial gateways within the region's jurisdiction, meet obligations equivalent to traditional operators and keep citizens' data on the continent; a recommendation, not an adopted instrument	Baseline not held

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National classification regime for official documents	Did not exist	Four levels of classification with access limited to cleared agents, traceability of transmissions, reinforced archiving and a ban on sending sensitive documents over private messaging or unsecured platforms	ADVANCED
Telecom and postal consumer complaint procedure	BASELINE NOT HELD	A binding escalation path: complain to the operator first and allow a maximum of 30 working days, then refer to the regulator by a free line, an online form or physical filing, with a reasoned opinion undertaken within 30 days	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Mobile network service in conflict-held eastern territories	One territory centre off all networks from March 2025 because generator fuel could not reach tower sites	Baraka and Fizi telecoms and internet cut for months amid operations against Twiraneho/AFC-M23 near Epupu; humanitarian NGOs' Starlink kits seized on the Baraka mayor's order, closing the last backup channel; rights defenders demand restoration	REGRESSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National network of data protection officers	Did not exist	A national network live, supported by two civil-society bodies and framed as alignment with the continental convention; the first concrete step under article 262 since 2023	ADVANCED
National data protection authority	Required by article 262 of the code; the decree never drafted or signed and the body non-operational	Still not created; the minister said in March 2026 that structuring a professional network precedes its creation, and it was named again in July as a link in the cybersecurity chain	NO CHANGE
Nationwide social-media restriction	The restriction had ended before the window opened and no acknowledged legal basis was ever stated	No further nationwide restriction recorded to 2026-08-06; the 2025 shutdown count for the country is attributed to the eastern conflict rather than to a national order	NO CHANGE

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Permanent state-industry consultation framework for the digital sector	Did not exist	Agreed as a standing mechanism between the ministry and the Réseau des acteurs du numérique after the dispute over the digital-sector tariff; no constituting text, membership or meeting schedule stated	ADVANCED

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Bill on access to information and transparency in public life	Did not exist	Admissible and in commission; it sets access as the norm and limitation the exception, applies to public services and some private actors, requires a simple, fast and free request procedure, proactive publication, reasoned refusals and a right of appeal	ADVANCED

The two positions that define the section are unchanged. The [Code du numérique is in force as it was](#), and the [authority its article 262 requires is still not created](#) — the same finding two years running, alongside a twenty-year exclusive foreign concession over citizens' identity data. What did appear is a [national network of data protection officers, live since March 2026](#), described as the first concrete step under article 262 since 2023. It moves the enforcement gap without closing it.

Legislative activity ran in both directions from nothing. A [bill on access to information was declared admissible on 27 March 2026](#) and a [bill on the identification of natural persons was tabled on 12 June](#); in the other direction, a [classification regime for official documents](#) was presented to the Council of Ministers. None has been adopted.

The mandate itself was redrawn: the 2026 finance law [renamed both sections and moved credits from FC 145.7bn to FC 55.1bn and from FC 60.6bn to FC 226.7bn](#). Combined, the two are almost flat as a share of the budget. One regional deadline passed unmet: the [free-roaming resolution required effective implementation across Central Africa by 30 June 2026](#), with no implementation or tariff held.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
AI-assisted business-plan platform	Did not exist	A live public platform giving step-by-step business-plan drafting, financial projections, export and direct submission with real-time file tracking	ADVANCED
Congolese academy of artificial intelligence	Did not exist	A provision on paper to train young talent and stimulate applied research, financed within the plan's envelope; no site, budget line, governing text or date established	ADVANCED
Lingala language data collection for AI	Did not exist	A digital economy ministry project with UNDP support to build Lingala training data for AI models; no corpus size, licence, host or publication date stated	ADVANCED
National artificial intelligence strategy	Did not exist	A draft on four pillars — governance, ethics, trust and regulation; data, digital and energy infrastructure; human capital, research and innovation; industrialisation and value creation — aligned to the national development plan on a 2030 horizon; technically validated over 23 to 27 July 2026 and referred to the Council of Ministers for adoption on 2026-08-04, with no adoption date established and the text not published	ADVANCED
Student artificial-intelligence facility	Did not exist	An announced facility to equip students with advanced technological skills, announced with state-data migration and a government cybersecurity centre; no design, budget line, site or date established	ADVANCED
Artificial-intelligence marking of the state examination	BASELINE NOT HELD	AI used to mark the 2024-25 state examination, alongside electronic diplomas and decentralised scanning centres	Baseline not held
Common AI-governance steering architecture	BASELINE NOT HELD	Officials on the record that bodies already acting across digital, research, data, cybersecurity and regulation have roles not yet sufficiently articulated in a common steering architecture	Baseline not held

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Local-content subcontracting enforcement in telecoms	Did not exist	Two regulators agreed to coordinate, with scope stated beyond telecoms to electronic communications, digital services and electronic commerce; no signed instrument, no inspection conducted and no reporting obligation established	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Africa digital innovation summit, Kinshasa	Three prior editions run under a different name in partnership with a Moroccan firm	Renamed and localised, organised by a Congolese firm with a fintech-association partnership, an innovation village, free student entry and presidency backing	ADVANCED
Femintech artificial-intelligence and computing training	The programme running since 2017 with about 1,000 girls trained in total	The same programme with one further cohort: 41 certificates, one of them to a boy; the cumulative total still stated as about 1,000	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Startup Act implementing decrees	Four draft decrees adopted May 2025 to operationalise the fiscal, customs and exchange advantages of the 2022 ordinance-law, none in force	The same four texts still in preparation; the agency was created by decree in October 2021 and no exemption regime for startups or digital small businesses is in force fifteen months on	STALLED

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital infrastructure and cybersecurity partnership	Did not exist	A framework covering data centres, connectivity, cybersecurity, financial technology and artificial intelligence; no value, instrument type, milestones or delivery established	ADVANCED
Payments-modernisation claim in a United States federal court	Did not exist	A claim seeking up to US\$400m on a stated investment of more than US\$72m against an agreed US\$20m state contribution never paid, with bribe-demand allegations; the government calls the signed documents a non-binding memorandum and denies the claims; no ruling is held	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Congo River fibre-optic memorandum	Did not exist	About 2,100 km — 1,700 km along the river plus nearly 400 km terrestrial — at a stated US\$1.5bn with more than US\$400m required for the first phase; no financing close, contract or works	ADVANCED
Police cooperation accord	Did not exist	Chinese technical assistance to the national police naming cybercrime alongside urban crime and mining fraud, with a standing joint working group	ADVANCED

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Data-centre investment talks	Did not exist	Exploratory talks with a proposed technical-specification working group; no memorandum, site, capacity or follow-up recorded six months on	ADVANCED

The AI strategy went from not existing to **technically validated and not adopted** in ten months, drafting having been launched in October 2025 with external support. The startup regime went the other way: **four draft decrees adopted in May 2025 are still in preparation**, so no exemption regime for startups or digital small businesses is in force.

External relationships were the section's real movement, all of them from nothing and none of them delivering yet. A Chinese supplier memorandum covers **about 2,100 km along the Congo River at a stated US\$1.5bn** — the country's largest single tracked non-state digital commitment, and a memorandum. A **police cooperation accord signed in Beijing** names cybercrime, with no text, equipment list or oversight arrangement. A **United States partnership covering data centres, connectivity, cybersecurity and AI** carries no value or milestones, and **Gulf data-centre talks recorded no memorandum, site or capacity six months on**. In the same window a fintech **filed in a United States federal court seeking up to US\$400m** over a collapsed payments-modernisation project.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Universal service fund pilot sites	The fund created by law in November 2020 and, per a named civil-society officer, still not available	Subsidy conventions signed with four operators for a first tranche of 40 localities (about 258,000 people); a national diagnostic published 2026-08-07 finds nearly 3,000 uncovered localities (about 4.3m people) against national coverage of 77% 2G, 68% 3G and 57% 4G (September 2025); a second phase of 300 sites (about 1.8m people) is planned, with a 2030 target of 3,000 localities, 16m people and 100 digital community centres	ADVANCED
Population without mobile coverage	Baseline not held	About 4.3 million people in nearly 3,000 localities without mobile coverage; national 2G coverage 77%, 3G 68% and 4G 57%, ranging from about 98% in Kinshasa to 14% in Tshuapa and 28% in each of Kwango and Sud-Ubangi (2026-08-07)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Mobile data bundle prices and validity	1GB valid 48 hours at 1,500 Congolese francs; 2GB valid 48 hours at 2,000 francs	1GB valid 24 hours at 1,500 francs, and the 2GB bundle replaced by 1GB valid 72 hours at 2,000 francs (2026-08)	REGRESSED
Rural civil-servant payroll	Did not exist	Rollout scoped to three named territories and others where no other bank operates; August 2026 named as a target, with the bank's director-general saying a fixed date is premature and the state contract unsigned, and its core banking replacement still in test	ADVANCED
Financial inclusion rate	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 58% financial inclusion against 25 to 30% bank-account penetration, the gap attributed to mobile-money use without a bank account	Baseline not held

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National digital code awareness campaign	Did not exist	2,000 young volunteers mobilised for 30 days at two publications a day on the code's provisions on cybersecurity, data protection and responsible internet use, carried by the digital economy ministry with UNDP support	ADVANCED
National policy on information technology in education and training	Did not exist	A common reference framework for integration, governance, use and regulation of information technology across education, higher education, research, vocational training and literacy, on 19 operational principles in six normative families	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Employment and skills platform	Did not exist	Live: jobseekers register profiles and skills and employers post needs, intended to build a national skills database	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
National digital plan human-capital targets	No numeric national training target is held at the window's start	250,000 young people to be trained in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and programming, at least 3,000 in advanced digital skills, about 1,000 teachers in digital literacy and 30,000 cybersecurity jobs, all to 2030	ADVANCED

The universal service fund is the strongest movement in this section: from a fund created by law in 2020 and, on a named civil-society officer's account, [still not available at February 2025, to first pilot connectivity sites under construction in Kongo Central](#) with a community digital-learning centre attached. No site count, budget or appropriation line for the fund is held at either end.

Skills targets appeared where none had been stated. The national digital plan now sets [250,000 young people to be trained in AI, cybersecurity and programming, at least 3,000 in advanced digital skills and about 1,000 teachers, to 2030](#). Six months on, no enrolment against any of them is established. The largest cohort recorded in the window is [41 certificates awarded in November 2025](#) on a programme whose cumulative total is still stated as about 1,000 since 2017.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Eastcastle Debt II (IFC debt facility)	Did not exist	US\$34.35m IFC debt financing proposed for Eastcastle Infrastructure DRC to expand shared telecom tower infrastructure and mobile broadband capacity	ADVANCED
Tower operator investment convention	Did not exist	More than US\$100m committed to extend connectivity in Kinshasa and the provinces, with more than 4,000 jobs stated as already created	ADVANCED
Tower platform senior facility	A US\$30m commitment in 2023 supporting tower purchase and development, with the network at 1,072 active towers	US\$32.8m inside a US\$179m upsized facility funding 728 new passive towers to take the network to 1,800, 70% of them rural, plus solar and battery upgrades	ADVANCED

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Central bank card-network memorandum	Did not exist	Three pillars: technical capacity building, financial inclusion and literacy, and secure resilient payment systems, aligned to the bank's 2026-2030 plan	ADVANCED
Digital economy ministry memorandum with a commercial bank	Not held	Signed between the digital economy ministry and a commercial bank to modernise the financial ecosystem and accelerate banking inclusion, covering digital identity and artificial-intelligence integration under the 2019 national digital plan and the 2023 Digital Code	BASELINE NOT HELD

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-20	MOVEMENT
Digital economy section appropriation	FC 60,627,481,411 domestic for FY2025, revised, with no original appropriation published	FC 81,698,223,741 domestic for FY2026, appropriated	ADVANCED
Posts and telecommunications section appropriation	FC 40,138,356,283 domestic for FY2025, revised	FC 53,840,917,417 domestic for FY2026, appropriated	ADVANCED
Digital economy section expenditure chain	BASELINE NOT HELD	FC 31,358,784,468 paid, 51.7% of the revised credit, against FC 68,457,537,329 engaged, or 112.9%	Baseline not held
National identification system appropriation	BASELINE NOT HELD	FC 20,654,178 appropriated for FY2026	Baseline not held

Private capital moved with dated figures at both ends. A development fund's commitment went from **US\$30m in 2023**, when the network stood at **1,072 active towers**, to **US\$32.8m inside an upsized US\$179m facility funding 728 new towers to take it to 1,800**, 70% of them rural. Separately an **investment convention of more than US\$100m** was signed with the investment-promotion agency.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Functioning national incident-response capability	a founding instrument for a computer emergency response team, an incident report or advisory, or an international cybersecurity assessment for the country	not yet probed
National technical-capacity base	a named compute or high-performance computing facility, a national technical or testing institution with a dated status, or a skills-for-infrastructure programme with enrolment figures	not yet probed
Energy provision for digital infrastructure	a utility-operator power agreement, a dated telecom-site electrification programme with site counts, or a data-centre power-purchase arrangement	not yet probed
National data governance strategy	the strategy document or the decree adopting it	not yet probed
National open-data policy or portal	a decree creating an open-data portal, a statistics-institute microdata release policy, or the access-to-information bill once adopted	not yet probed
EU digital governance or regulatory cooperation	the EU financing agreement or gateway package document, or an EU delegation statement on digital regulation, data adequacy or governance support	not yet probed
Use of satellite or earth-observation data in public administration	a statistics-institute, planning-ministry, land-administration or agriculture-ministry statement naming an earth-observation data source or a satellite-imagery procurement	not yet probed
India-DR Congo digital or technology engagement	an India-DR Congo memorandum, line of credit, training placement or Indian supplier contract naming the country	not yet probed
FY2026 budget execution	the budget ministry's monthly or quarterly execution statements for the 2026 exercise	not yet probed
Audited outturn for the digital sections	the audit court's general report or the settlement law for FY2024, at section grain	not yet probed
Gender-disaggregated connectivity or usage	a mobile-industry gender-gap country cut, or a statistics-institute or central-bank survey with sex-disaggregated tables	not yet probed
National digital literacy rate or skills baseline	an international digital-skills indicator for the country, a household survey module, or the sectoral policy's baseline annexe	not yet probed
Domestic public funding for digital and AI research	a finance-law section or programme line for scientific research, or the AI strategy's costed roadmap	not yet probed

Fourteen rows carry no position at either end, so no movement can be stated for them. Four are institutional: no incident-response capability, no technical-capacity base, no energy provision for digital infrastructure, and no data governance strategy — the last named by the minister in July 2026 as an instrument the state already holds. Three concern openness and outside engagement: no open-data policy or portal, no European Union cooperation instrument, and no India engagement of any kind.

The rest bear directly on this document. Two are measures nobody publishes — a digital literacy rate and any gender-disaggregated connectivity figure — and two are the finance-layer absences that stop the appropriations above being read against delivery: no FY2026 budget execution, and no audited outturn at section grain. The FY2024 accounts are audited and closed, but neither the audit-court report nor the settlement law is obtainable. Each row is in `gaps.csv` with what would settle it; none has yet been probed on a date.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-20-2
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/COD/COD-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/COD/COD-progress-2026-08-20-2.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.